

One year	\$1.50
Six Months	.75
Three Months	.35
Single Copies	10c

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THE SPIRIT THAT GAVE being to the Willamette Valley Development association, organized permanently at Albany, Saturday, is the sort that builds empires. The more intense the spirit, the greater the constructive results. This valley is an empire—Clackamas, Marion, Lane, Linn, Polk, Washington, Yamhill and Benton counties.

The counties that make up the valley have no superior anywhere on earth in fertility, richness, industry, wealth and diversity of products. Each has been boosting itself along more or less indifferently without reference to the others. Finally some resourceful man or men saw a light.

Why not all of us in the valley get together through our commercial, granger, editorial, farmer and other organizations, make up a common pot of effort and money and enthusiasm to develop and build and most in concert? It is more economical. There is less waste of energy in unity. The results must be greater. It was a good idea and Albany pushed it.

A temporary organization was formed. Other counties, including Clackamas, were invited to get in, and Saturday, representatives from the "Big Seven" gathered in Albany, talked over the plans, purposes and results and then formed a compact to do things—all for each and each for all.

C. E. Spence, of the grange; Thomas A. Burke, of the Oregon City Commercial club, and Adam Knight, county commissioner, represented Clackamas county. They took an active part in the association. A. L. Fisher, of Albany, was elected president. The next meeting of the body will be called to name a directory, one from each county, and to outline a plan of campaign for the current year's work. The object of the organization as set forth in the constitution and by-laws are these:

"To promote and work for the general welfare of the counties of the Willamette valley; to correlate and concentrate organized efforts along those lines in which the interests of the counties and publicity and promotion clubs of the member counties are identical; to determine upon and take such action with reference thereto as shall be deemed best for the interest of said counties and cities in order to promote the general and material welfare.

"To develop more and better markets, to bring the said counties and cities new commercial enterprises; to secure additional and different and better transportation facilities; to make said counties and cities more attractive and more desirable business centers; to devise ways and means for the benefit of existing agricultural, mercantile and manufacturing enterprises; to create a spirit of cooperation among said counties for the mutual benefit and development, and to do any and all things for the general promotion of the entire Willamette valley."

THE PROPOSED RURAL CREDIT BILL, which the recent Salem conference discussed and which will be initiated by bill to be voted on at the November election, authorizes the state land board to issue 4 per cent serial bonds in an amount which will not exceed in the aggregate, 2 per cent of the assessed valuation of the property in the state.

The funds derived from the sale of these bonds shall be let on farms throughout the state at 6 per cent, which is the same rate at which the irrevocable state school funds are now loaned. This provision prevents the danger of a lower rate of interest on the rural credit fund militating against the loans from the school fund.

No person owning land assessed at \$20,000 or more will be considered for a loan, it being regarded that a person holding that much property is in a condition to finance himself. Loans will be made only to people who are resident on their farms, and no loan shall be made in excess of \$10,000 regardless of the security offered.

Profits accruing from the difference between the interest the state pays on its rural credit bonds and the interest it receives from the fund as loaned, are to become a part of the state school fund to be administered under the rules governing it.

Whenever the approved applications for loans aggregate more than \$100,000 the state land board is authorized to advertise and sell a series of bonds sufficient to accommodate all applicants, with the exception that the amount of the bonds must never aggregate more than 2 per cent of the total assessed valuation of property in the state. The bonds will be known as "Rural Credit State Bonds" and will be exempt from all taxes levied within the state.

F. S. Myers, who is chairman of the committee to draft and submit the measures, outlined the effects of the proposed measure if it is passed at the election, as follows, before the Civic league:

"First—It will bring into the state of Oregon, within a few months after its enactment, approximately \$19,000,000 of new capital.

"Second—It will reduce the rate of interest on farm loans to thousands of farmers from 8, 9 and 10 per cent to 6 per cent.

"Third—By providing long-term loans at 6 per cent, farmers will be encouraged to employ labor in clearing and subduing land which is now idle. This will give employment to a large number of laborers.

"Fourth—The difference between the price which the state will pay for its rural credit money and the rate of interest which it will receive from farmers will rapidly build up a large state school fund.

"By the end of the 12th year more than twice as much interest will be received by the state as the state will be required to pay on its bonds. If it is decided to issue bonds maturing in 35 years, after the 25th year the state will owe \$19,000,000 and have loaned on farms \$39,533,991. At the end of the 35th year the state will owe \$19,000,000 and have farm mortgages aggregating \$60,669,587, or a clear surplus of \$41,669,587."

The Invitation

Every individual who handles money is invited to use this bank. Firms and corporations just beginning business or those who have not as yet accepted the offer of our banking service are cordially invited to deposit their funds with this bank under the assurance that they will receive prompt, courteous and efficient service.

If you cannot come to the bank in person you may send your deposit by mail. It will be promptly acknowledged and the proper pass book and check books mailed you.

4 PER CENT INTEREST
Paid on Time Certificates

The Bank of Oregon City
OLDEST BANK IN CLACKAMAS COUNTY

THAT OREGON CITY AND CLACKAMA COUNTY are sharing in the prosperity that seems to be coming our way now finds concrete evidence in some of the big public and private expenditures that are being made this year in the way of repairs, construction and betterments.

The Enterprise Sunday pointed out a number of things that are and will call for the spending of more than \$1,250,000 during the current year. The chances are that the amount will exceed \$2,000,000 before the close of the twelfth month.

This money is paid out here, and for the most part will be spent in Oregon City. It means the employment of many hundred men and women, directly and indirectly. It means that the business and professional men and women will share in it. The store-keeper and craftsmen as well as the laborer and builder and mechanic alike will absorb some of it.

Considered in the bulk, the amount is at once encouraging and stimulating to the citizen who has not taken the time to think about it. Aside from the \$750,000 going into the new Hawley paper mills addition, the \$50,000 into the woolen mills extensions, \$300,000 in county road and repair work, \$200,000 in betterments on the Willamette Valley Southern road, there are many thousands being put into the improvements at the government locks just across the river.

All of these are exclusive of the general building to be done in the city, which is likely to be more extensive, because of the impulse and confidence that we naturally follow prosperous conditions. The bank statements published this week give further evidence of the good times that are already here. Deposits in each of the three financial institutions show helpful increases. And general business and tone of them reflect influences that radiate better things all around and make the spirit to boost contagious.

Other signs of prosperity are found in the greater activity, also brighter and happier faces of everybody. While these qualities are, of course, incidental only, they are logical and inevitable. They are a sort of barometer. And still another mark of flush times may be noted in the lessening disposition of the town "knocker" to civil. Nobody has the inclination or time to listen to him. Ignored, he naturally has to quit.

GOVERNOR WITHYCOMBE takes a sane stand in regard to the development of the state water power. His remarks concerning the Ferris bill are reasonable and sound. The aim of this measure is to preserve the water power of the state. "And what for?" the governor asks. "I would rather see one stream developed than a score preserved."

The executive then continues: "It is estimated that Oregon has some five million horsepower in its streams. Thus far less than half a million have been filed upon, or about one-tenth; and, of course, much less actually have been developed."

"Yet we are told to beware of monopoly. Too often when corporate interests threaten to invest in Oregon, the bugaboo of monopoly is waved before us, and such a commotion is raised that the investor, troubled by the outlook, takes his checkbook and his payroll and his tax money elsewhere."

"It may be rank heresy, and the words are open to misinterpretation but for myself I would rather see a payroll created by a 'wicked' so-called monopoly, or a sinful 'power-grabber' than to see the wasting water so utilized flow forever to the sea without turning a wheel."

"And in this connection recollect that Oregon has a public service commission and excellent and adequate laws governing corporations and utilities. Exorbitant rates cannot be charged. Only a reasonable return upon the investment is allowed. The public is safeguarded from mulching through excessive charges."

"Today some 57 per cent of Oregon's area is untaxed. That means about 43 per cent of the state pays the running expenses of the whole. About that, you will admit, is not a situation apt to arouse enthusiasm in prospective taxpayers."

MEMBERS OF THE DELEGATION that went to Salem Wednesday to interview the state highway commission in regard to state aid for Clackamas county road work returned with assurances that local projects would be earnestly considered when the 1917 apportionments were made, but with no cash. Clackamas county made its first appeal for state aid and found itself too late.

Clackamas county, with an assessed valuation of \$30,000,000, has been taxed for years to maintain the state highway board along with the rest of the state, yet has received no returns. Every cent raised in this county has gone to other parts of the state, even though the main north and south road of western Oregon cuts through the county.

The New Era-Oregon City section of the Pacific highway is certainly worthy of the combined efforts of county and state. The present route is crooked and has many hills, yet the proposed route along the track of the Southern Pacific will give a shorter and level course to the south. Clackamas county asks for only \$20,000 for this work, only a trifle over the annual contribution of the county to the state fund.

The Commercial club, the county court and every public spirited citizen in the county should keep in touch with the situation until the county gets favorable action from the commission—until Clackamas county is awarded what it deserves.

THE WILLAMETTE VALLEY HOG RAISERS' excursion and convention held recently at the Union Stock Yards and organized by the efforts of the Oregon Electric Railway and Union Stock Yards companies, brought to the great livestock market over two hundred farmers. Many of them were enlightened on phases of their business as no other method would have done. They took away different ideas about the northwest livestock market.

It was noted there were several conversions, one of them being that fair prices were being paid considering the poor quality of a vast amount of porkers dumped into the market by the "ins" getting "out."

By this meeting and by the campaign waged at country meetings there were impressed upon the visitors (very few of whom had ever visited the market), the following facts:

competition in selling; weighing by a disinterested scaler; fairness of dockage; publicity of stock yards records; the grading of stock; the necessity of a selling agency; the requirements of top-notch stuff to command best prices; and finally, the assurance of a square deal.—Oregon Voter.

THE ENTERPRISE congratulates the county court in appointing T. A. Roots road boss and S. A. Cobb road engineer. From standpoint of business judgment and in the interests of better roads, the employment of these two men, who will act as assistants to the county court, is a wise move.

Mr. Roots, after many years work in Multnomah county, and two years spent in the Clackamas district as road supervisor, is a thoroughly practical man, and Mr. Cobb is able to handle the engineering problems in connection with the work.

The Enterprise has always contended that it was impossible for a county court, headed by a county judge who must attend to probate and juvenile matters in addition to the hundred and one of the county affairs that come before him, to supervise properly the expenditure of a \$225,000 road fund and to administer other county business. But with the aid of these two practical and experienced men, the county court will be able to keep in a closer touch with road affairs at all times, the supervisors will profit by the advice of the traveling ambassadors of the county court, and the taxpayers in general will profit accordingly.

ROAD DRAINAGE URGED

PORTLAND, Ore., March 7.—(Editor of The Enterprise.)—Another word, please, on road drainage. I do not need to call attention to the fact that the

subject of good roads is the most important one in Oregon, nor that drainage is indispensable in the making of them. What I do want to impress on the minds of the people is the fact that the

LYNN NICKERSON AND "DICK" DICKSON PLAY THE MODERN TOM SAWYER AND "HUCK" FINN, ARE NABBED BY POLICE CHIEF, LECTURED BY DISTRICT ATTORNEY

Here are the modern Tom Sawyer and "Huck" Finn of Clackamas. Lynn Nickerson, 13 years old, son of G. F. Nickerson, former captain in the Oregon National Guard; Richard Dickson, age 13, son of Captain H. B. Dickson, U. S. A., retired, all of Gladstone, are been companions, "partners" with the same ambition—a cadetship at West Point U. S. academy—and obsessed with the same military esprit de corps.

They "framed" an escapade with thrills. It was Saturday in Gladstone and their holiday, because there was no school that day. It was dull there. Young Nickerson got his father's pistol—old army Colt's—and strapped it about "Dick" Dickson who proceeded to Gladstone park for adventure. Shots rang out later in the park. It was "Dick" Dickson "pulling down" an Indian—imaginary Indian. Over near home Young Nickerson was waiting.

ing patiently by the side of a cynose, property of "Dick's." Hearing the shots, he leaped on the horse and "burned the wind" for the park. It was his signal. Hearing "Dick," he found him in custody of Chief of Police liell, under arrest and scared. Thrills that were to be only make-believe had eventuated into the real thing, at least to "Dick." Both were brought to Oregon City, lectured by the district attorney against such promiscuous "stunts" and sent home.

their roads are not drained at all.

No side drain on ditch has a current in it, unless, indeed, it is fed by a spring or from adjoining land; and, inasmuch as the side drains are a part of the road, and they carry away no water, the roads are not drained.

To drain anything means to take water away from it.

An inspection of the lower end of a tile drain will show a stream of water running from it whenever the ground above it is wet; but the side ditches show no such stream. They are a succession of pools from which the foundation of the roads are kept wet. What little water is taken from the surface is returned to weaken the subsoil.

The writer has been suggesting that two drains be put down about 18 feet apart, but now, he will widen the suggestion to 20 feet apart; for if a road is to be hard-surfaced as many should and will be, the drains should be under or near the edges of the hard surface, so that they may be taken up in case of need of repair.

When a road is to be hard-surfaced, it will be much less costly than if the ground has not been kept dry by drainage. The costs of the drains, with interest, would be saved.

E. F. RILEY.

WHY OLE BOT A FORD.

A Molalla man recently sent the following letter to Henry Ford, according to the Aurora Observer:

Dear Mr. Ford, Ay tell you why ay shall buy Ford machine instead of automobile. Ay shall tel you. In the 1st place folks round here aint go in much for style, and if I get Buick or Overground car dey tink ay am all stuck up. Dis vay day tank ay make him myself. In 2 place, ay like it, cause it ben ride just like vagon I usta haul milk in. Another thing, Mr. Ford, your car ant no horn for hooting, and if I get run over by Southern Pacific or Grant Dimick Southern ay sure get damage caus all my nabors will avar ay could never hear vessel on train coming. Some peepul have trouble cranking Ford. Das all fooliness. Ay never have to crank more as 20 minutes, and if he don't go den is too late to start anyhow.

Yours truly,
Olaf L.

MUST HIT 300 OR QUIT

THAT IS THE ULTIMATUM WILLE GETS FROM M'CREIDIE.

PORTLAND, Ore., March 14.—McCreidie, of the Portland Beavers, delivered the second ultimatum to Outfielder Dave Wille, who was turned over to Portland by the Cleveland Americans. In reply to the judge's wire, in which there was an offer of an increase in the salary offered, Wille stated that he wanted a bonus if he batted .275 or better in the Pacific Coast league.

Wille is supposed to be a .300 hitter and the judge penciled out the following telegram to the ex-Nap: "You will have to hit .300 to hold your job. We have given you all we can." It is expected that Wille will surrender and accept the terms offered, which are much more than he received in the American association last season.

The judge has not heard a word from Bobby Vaughn, and furthermore, the Portland chief does not care whether he does. "Portland has done the right thing by Vaughn," said the judge today, "and if he does not report, Walter has plenty of players so that he can switch them around into a fast combination."

Owen Quinn, the Syracuse first sacker, is a great fielder and could be converted into a second baseman, and Louis Gusito, the St. Mary's college star, could handle the first base position to a nicety. The other combination would be Quinn on first and Hollacher on second.

GOTCH WINS HIS BOUT

CHAMPION SHOWS GOOD FORM IN ALL THREE BOUTS.

SAN DIEGO, Cal., March 13.—Frank Gotch, world's undefeated champion wrestler, came back in good form yesterday and easily defeated Herman Strech, army and navy champion; Sam Clapham, the "British Lion," and Jack White, of San Francisco. The matches were staged at the Savoy theatre before 1500 fans.

Strech grappled with Gotch first. The soldier adopted a defensive attitude and put up a good struggle. Fourteen minutes and 30 seconds after the start, however, the champion secured a scissors hold on Gotch and put him to the mat.

Clapham put up a game battle but Gotch increased his speed and took the rest fall in nine minutes. White was the easiest of the three and lasted but seven minutes and 30 seconds. His downfall was caused by a head scissors and bar lock.

'T WAS EVER THUS.

'Tis Saturday night in early fall. The village swain sets forth to call. He's all doped up and sure steps high in a new brown derby and new necktie.

He strides along the town's one street. To give the country dames a treat. But as he hears the lady's home. A nervous fear seeps through his dome.

For this poor boob's in love, that's all.

A state to which the wisest fall.

Before the door he stands, poor Joe. Afraid to stay, afraid to go. But the fair damsel is on the job. For hours she's camped by the old door knob.

She sends her sister to say to the lout. "I'll see if she is in or out." She leads "it" to the parlor, where She seats "it" in the smallest chair. There the nut will sit and grin Until the lady fair comes in.

She hesitates upon the stair. As if surprised to see him there. Then, with him sitting in full view She curries out, "Oh, is it you?" A fitting sequel to this mess. The poor flathead replies with "Yes."

She lands the fish that very night. It doesn't even want to fight. The worst is that he thinks that he Has landed her, and she'll agree That—she with downcast bashful eyes That she was taken by surprise.

The family, knowing the fish has bit, Comes in to take a look at it. The tale is old, and sad, and yet It's true; on that I'll make a bet.

The moral is, that if you fall, Don't think you did it, that is all.

—I. T. H., in Los Angeles Times.

6 TEAMS IN NORTHWEST LEAGUE

SEATTLE, Wash., March 12.—The Northwestern baseball league will operate as a six club circuit in 1916. This became assured today when it was learned that arrangements for placing a team in Great Falls, Mont., practically had been completed.

The circuit will include Seattle, Vancouver, Spokane, Tacoma, Butte and Great Falls. In the event that negotiations in Great Falls fail at the eleventh hour, Wallace, Idaho, which has asked for a franchise and shown the color of its coin to back the request, probably will be considered.

Springfield will vote on \$30,000 high school.

CAPT. DICKSON READY TO RETURN TO ARMY

Captain H. B. Dickson, U. S. A., retired and residing at Gladstone, is awaiting orders from the war department at Washington, D. C., calling him to duty as a result of the call for troops for Mexican service.

Captain Dickson has been retired several years, on account of ill-health. He was a captain in the Twelfth cavalry, U. S. A., part of which is now en route to the Mexican border for service there. Captain Dickson has a splendid record in the army and is anxious to offer his service again to his country.

LOCAL MAN IS HONORED

ED FORTUNE WILL BE OFFICIAL AT STATE FAIR RACES.

Ed Fortune, of Oregon City, has received a communication from Secretary A. H. Lea, of the state fair, informing him that he will be official timer for the trotting races and official starter for the running events.

Mr. Fortune, who is well known in horse racing circles throughout the state, has acted in an official capacity at Canby, as well as at other towns through the valley.

He is not communicating with fair secretaries and racing managers of other county fairs and a meeting of these men to arrange dates and programs will be held in Oregon City soon.

PORTER WILL FILED

The will of the late R. W. Porter of Gladstone was filed in the county court Tuesday for probate. An estate of \$2100 is left to the surviving widow, Mrs. Amanda Porter, who asks to be made executrix. There are two sons and two daughters, one of the former, Clarence W. Porter, resides in Fairbanks, Alaska. R. W. Porter died at his home February 12.

Residents of Malin 35 miles south of Klamath Falls working for electric road from Malin to Klamath Falls via Poe Valley and Olene.



What The Public Wants To Know

By O. W. Eastham,
Republican Candidate
For District Attorney

The community is not really interested in the office-seeker's "glad hand" or his well arranged line of "bunk."

- The public wants an answer to two questions:
1. Is he able to "deliver the goods."
 2. Is he determined, in dead earnest, to "deliver the goods?"

What does a candidate for the Republican nomination mean in saying "It may be necessary to have special counsel to help out?" (Letter to the Enterprise dated January 26.) Does he mean that he may not be able to "deliver the goods," or does he mean to place his O. K. on the employment of special counsel to assist the present District Attorney—one single fee that I know of being \$250?

What does the same candidate mean (same letter) in saying, "It may be necessary to expend Several Hundred Dollars a year for the purpose of Hiring Detectives?" Does he mean that the Sheriff and his force of deputies may not do the work the County pays them to do, or does he mean to place his O. K. on the Levings job, Approved By The Present District Attorney, which cost the County about \$2500? Indeed the County has had some detective experience and Oregon City Has Had Some.

My statement, published two weeks ago, was: "This year, as a fair estimate, the office will cost between \$5000 and \$6000. The amount should be \$2100 and no more." The present District Attorney Has Not Challenged That Statement.

I said that "The Expense Of The Office Will Be Just \$2100 If I Am On The Job." No loophole there for "Expense of Special Counsel" or "Hire of Detectives." No chance to arrive at the same old \$5000 result under a different system of book-keeping.

(Paid Adv. by O. W. Eastham, residence, 620 11th St., Oregon City, Ore.)